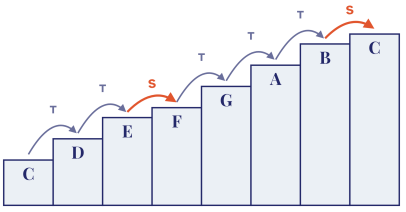
SCALES AND KEYS · SCALES · LEARN

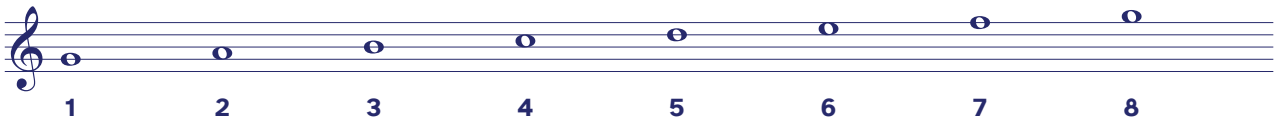
Scales and keys



REMEMBER Every major scale has the same pattern: T T S T T T S.

1 Fix the scale ★★☆

This should be G major, but one note is missing its sharp. Add it, then answer.



the note that needs a sharp ☐ semitones between degrees ☐ – ☐ and ☐ – ☐

2 The major pattern ★☆☆

Write T or S between each pair of degrees.

1 [T] 2 [T] 3 [ ] 4 [ ] 5 [ ] 6 [ ] 7 [ ] 8

3 Degree names ★☆☆

Write the name of each degree.

DEGREE	NAME	DEGREE	NAME
1	tonic	2	
5		3	
4		6	
7			

4 Relative minor ★★☆

Each major key shares its key signature with a minor key. To find it, go down a minor 3rd: count 2 keys between, then land.

C major → **A** minor

G major → ☐ minor

F major → ☐ minor

D major → ☐ minor

B♭ major → ☐ minor

E♭ major → ☐ minor

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · MINOR SCALES · LEARN

Minor scales

REMEMBER Natural minor: the major on the same note with 3, 6 and 7 one key lower. Harmonic minor: raise the 7th again.

1 Which notes move?

★☆☆

From C major to C natural minor, three degrees move one key lower. Write their numbers.

☐ ☐ ☐

2 Build it

★★☆

Write the notes of each scale, going up. The first is done.

SCALE	NOTES
C natural minor	**C D E♭ F G A♭ B♭ C**
D natural minor	
A harmonic minor	
D harmonic minor	
E natural minor	

3 Melodic minor

★★☆

Write A melodic minor going up, then coming down.

	NOTES
going up	
coming down	

4 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

C natural minor starts on the same note as C major.	T F
The harmonic minor raises the 6th.	T F
Coming down, the melodic minor is the natural minor.	T F

5 Play it

★☆☆

Play C major, then C natural minor, then C harmonic minor. Bright, dark, then leaning home. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · SCALES · USE

Scales and keys

REMEMBER The order of sharps: F C G D A E B. The order of flats is the same, backwards.

1 Name the key

★★☆

Write the major key and its relative minor for each key signature. The first is done.



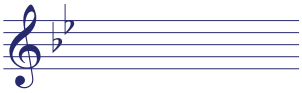
major G minor _____



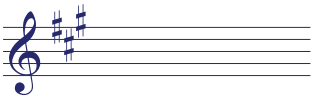
major _____ minor _____



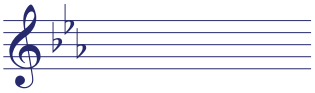
major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____

2 Which minor?

★★★

Three forms of A minor, going up. Write natural, harmonic or melodic under each.

A



_____

B



_____

C



_____

3 In order

★☆☆

Write the order of sharps and the order of flats.

Sharps							
Flats							

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play each scale one octave, hands separately. Tick a circle each day it is even and correct.

G major ○ ○ ○ ○ **F major** ○ ○ ○ ○ **A harmonic minor** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · FINDING THE KEY · USE

Finding the key

REMEMBER Sharps: the last sharp, then the very next key up. Flats: the second-last flat (one flat: F major). Then look for the clue note and the last note.

1 Name the major key

★★☆

Write the major key for each key signature. The first is done.

2 sharps → **D**

3 sharps → ☐

4 sharps → ☐

1 flat → ☐

2 flats → ☐

3 flats → ☐

2 Major or minor?

★★★

The key signature gives two suspects. The clue note (a raised 7th) and the last note name the key. The first is done.

KEY SIGNATURE	CLUE NOTE	LAST NOTE	KEY
1 sharp	D♯	E	**E minor**
none	G♯	A	
2 flats	F♯	G	
1 flat	none	F	
2 sharps	A♯	B	

3 The detective's steps

★☆☆

Number the steps 1, 2, 3 in the order you check them.

the last bass note ☐

the key signature ☐

the clue notes ☐

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	KEY
the key signature		☐
a clue note (a raised 7th)		☐
the last bass note		☐

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · THE CIRCLE OF FIFTHS · USE

The circle of fifths

REMEMBER Go right round the circle: one more sharp each step. Go left: one more flat.

1 Walk the circle

★★☆

Write the next keys round the circle, and how many sharps or flats each has. The first two are done.

	C	1	2	3	4	5
right	C · 0	G · 1♯				
left	C · 0	F · 1♭				

2 How many?

★★☆

Count the steps from C to find the number of sharps or flats.

A major ☐ sharps

E♭ major ☐ flats

E major ☐ sharps

B♭ major ☐ flats

B major ☐ sharps

A♭ major ☐ flats

3 Neighbours on the clock

★★☆

Write the key.

right of D ☐

left of C ☐

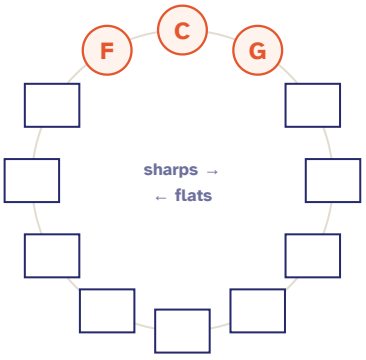
opposite C ☐

inside G (its relative minor) ☐

4 Fill the clock

★★☆

Write the twelve major keys round the clock. C, G and F are done. (At the bottom, one key has two names.)



5 Say it

★☆☆

Say the circle out loud, right and then left, without looking. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

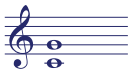
SCALES AND KEYS · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 8.

1 Intervals and keys ★★☆

Write the interval number for the first two; the major key for the last two.



interval _____



interval _____



major _____



major _____

2 Complete it ★★☆

One word, letter or number in each space.

The relative minor of G major is ☐ minor.

In a major scale the semitones fall between degrees 3–4 and ☐ .

The major key with one sharp is ☐ major.

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A key signature applies to every line of the piece.	T	F
C up to E is a 3rd.	T	F
A minor 3rd is four semitones.	T	F

Score ☐ **/ 10**

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
major scales	☐	☐	☐	p. 93
scale degree names	☐	☐	☐	p. 116
minor scales	☐	☐	☐	p. 96
key signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 99
finding the key	☐	☐	☐	p. 102
the circle of fifths	☐	☐	☐	p. 105

Teacher's note

Date _____

SCALES AND KEYS · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	F needs a sharp (F♯); semitones 3–4 and 7–8. Pattern: T T S T T T S. Degrees: 2 supertonic, 3 mediant, 4 subdominant, 5 dominant, 6 submediant, 7 leading note. Relative minors: E, D, B, G, C.
p. 2	Which move: 3, 6, 7. D natural minor D E F G A B♭ C D · A harmonic minor A B C D E F G♯ A · D harmonic minor D E F G A B♭ C♯ D · E natural minor E F♯ G A B C D E. Melodic up A B C D E F♯ G♯ A, down A G F E D C B A. T, F, T.
p. 3	Keys: G / E minor · F / D minor · D / B minor · B♭ / G minor · A / F♯ minor · E♭ / C minor. Minor forms: A harmonic, B natural, C melodic. Sharps F C G D A E B; flats B E A D G C F.
p. 4	Major keys: D, A, E, F, B♭, E♭. Major or minor: A minor, G minor, F major, B minor. Steps: 3, 1, 2.
p. 5	Right: D 2♯, A 3♯, E 4♯, B 5♯. Left: B♭ 2♭, E♭ 3♭, A♭ 4♭, D♭ 5♭. How many: 3, 3, 4, 2, 5, 4. Neighbours: A, F, F♯ / G♭, E minor. Clock, going right from C: G D A E B F♯/G♭ D♭ A♭ E♭ B♭ F.
p. 6	5th, 3rd, D major, F major · E, 7–8, G · T, T, F.

“Draw it”, “in your music”, listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____